Critical Incident Management Policy and Procedure

1. Purpose

This Policy and Procedure establish TIIS's institutional arrangements to prevent, prepare for, respond to, recover from and review critical incidents. It prioritises life, safety and wellbeing, protects students and staff, preserves academic and operational continuity, and ensures lawful notification, accountable decisions and continuous improvement.

2. Scope

This Policy applies to all TIIS students, staff, contractors and visitors; Sydney and Melbourne campuses; approved remote and online activities; and relevant third-party and transnational education (TNE) arrangements. It covers incidents on or off campus where TIIS has a duty of care or where the event materially affects a student, staff member, educational delivery or institutional operations. Statutory requirements apply according to their jurisdiction and scope; overseas TNE is not automatically subject to every ESOS obligation.

3. Policy Principles

- Protect life and obtain emergency assistance before administrative reporting.
- Respond promptly, proportionately and without prejudging allegations; use trauma-informed, culturally responsive and accessible support.
- Establish clear incident leadership, decision authority, contemporaneous records and need-to-know communications.
- Protect privacy, evidence and procedural fairness; avoid retaliation and unnecessary disclosure.
- Coordinate WHS, ESOS, student safety, sexual harm, cybersecurity and business continuity obligations where they overlap.
- Review material incidents and verify corrective actions rather than merely recording completion.

4. Definitions and Classification

A critical incident is an actual, suspected or threatened event that causes, or could reasonably cause, serious harm to a person, significant disruption to education or operations, major loss or compromise of information or assets, or material legal or regulatory consequences. For overseas-student requirements, TIIS also applies the critical incident definition and recordkeeping obligations in National Code Standard 6. For overseas student purposes, the National Code definition of a critical incident is a traumatic event, or the threat of such, within or outside Australia, which causes extreme stress, fear or injury. This definition is distinct from TIIS's broader institutional classification.

Classification	Examples and response
Emergency / immediate threat	Death, serious injury, fire, violence, immediate danger or acute medical crisis: contact 000, protect persons, activate site emergency arrangements.

Critical incident	Serious student welfare event, sexual assault, serious WHS incident, major cyber breach, prolonged campus closure, natural disaster, serious third-party delivery disruption: notify CEO immediately and activate coordinated response.
Significant incident / near miss	Material threat or serious near miss requiring prompt management assessment; escalate if severity, vulnerability or impact increases.

Classification is preliminary and must be revised as facts emerge. A matter may simultaneously trigger more than one reporting or response framework.

5. Incident Response and Escalation

Stage	Required action
1. Immediate protection	Call 000 where necessary; arrange first aid, evacuation or safe shelter; protect affected people; do not wait for managerial approval.
2. Report and triage	Notify the campus manager / Registrar and CEO promptly; record known facts, location, persons affected, immediate risks and actions.
3. Activate response	CEO appoints an incident lead and, for material incidents, activates a Critical Incident Management Team (CIMT) drawing on relevant functions.
4. Stabilise and support	Secure premises/systems, coordinate authorities, arrange student/staff welfare, consider academic adjustments and continuity measures.
5. Notify and communicate	Determine each statutory and contractual notification duty, accountable officer and deadline; issue controlled communications.
6. Recover and review	Implement recovery plan, preserve evidence, review causes and controls, assign corrective actions and report closure.

The CEO or delegate must immediately advise the Board Chair of a critical incident with serious safety, regulatory, financial, reputational or continuity implications. Urgent lawful protective action must not wait for a Board or committee meeting.

6. Governance and Responsibilities

Role	Accountability
Board of Directors	Approves this Policy; oversees institutional readiness, major exposures and corrective actions, subject to the Constitution and Members' reserved powers.
Audit and Risk Committee	Reviews material incident trends, controls and remediation and advises the Board; does not direct emergency operations.
Academic Board	Oversees academic quality, student progression and academic continuity implications within delegated authority.
CEO	Accountable for response leadership, CIMT activation, resources, regulatory escalation and Board reporting.
CIMT / EMT	Coordinates incident response, recovery, communications and assigned actions under CEO authority; EMT has no independent approval power absent delegation.
Registrar / Student Services	Leads student contact, welfare coordination, overseas-student records, academic support referrals and applicable PRISMS actions.

Campus managers / WHS leads	Implement site emergency plans, first aid, evacuation, immediate hazards controls and applicable WHS notifications.
Quality and Compliance Manager	Advises on reporting obligations, maintains compliance oversight and tests closure evidence without assuming first-line response ownership.
All staff and contractors	Immediately raise safety threats, report incidents and follow emergency instructions.

7. Student and Staff Welfare

TIIS will arrange proportionate welfare support, including first aid, emergency medical referral, counselling, reasonable study or work adjustments, alternative learning arrangements and referral to specialist services. Overseas students must be informed of relevant support and safety services under National Code Standard 6. Family, guardian, sponsor or consular contact must be assessed case by case, taking account of consent, privacy, safety, age and lawful disclosure requirements.

The Student Safety and Security Procedure provides practical guidance on orientation, personal safety, reporting and support. Allegations of sexual harm, gender-based violence, bullying or discrimination must also follow the applicable specialist policy, preserving procedural fairness and safeguarding affected persons.

8. Communication, Notification and Records

The CEO must assign an officer to identify applicable notification duties and statutory timeframes for each incident. Depending on the facts these may include police/emergency services, NSW or Victorian WHS regulators, TEQSA, ESOS agencies, the Department of Home Affairs, the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner, insurers, affected individuals or partner institutions. Not every incident requires notification to every authority; the notification decision and rationale must be recorded.

Only CEO-authorised personnel may make public or media statements on behalf of TIIS. Communications must be accurate, timely, accessible, privacy-conscious and coordinated with authorities where appropriate. The Registrar maintains the controlled Critical Incident Register (SE22), recording incident classification, actions, notifications, welfare support, responsible officers, corrective actions and closure evidence. The Registrar reports register status, material incidents, overdue actions and trends to the Audit and Risk Committee (ARC) quarterly, with urgent escalation of material incidents. Preserve an incident log, evidence, communications, welfare referrals, notification decisions and closure records. For critical incidents affecting overseas students, maintain the records required by National Code Standard 6, for at least two years after the overseas student ceases to be enrolled, or longer where required by law or an applicable retention schedule.

9. Preparedness, Training and Continuity

TIIS must maintain site-specific emergency arrangements, contact lists, evacuation and first aid provisions, and access to relevant business continuity and cyber incident plans. The CEO ensures role-based induction, incident reporting guidance, escalation contacts and proportionate exercises or tests. For online and TNE delivery, contracts and contingency plans must identify response contacts, partner duties, information-sharing and student support arrangements.

10. Post-Incident Review and Assurance

The CEO must ensure material incidents are reviewed after stabilisation, with appropriate independence where management decisions or serious misconduct are implicated. Reviews must identify contributing factors, timeliness, statutory compliance, student/staff impact, effectiveness of controls and lessons learned. Each corrective action must have an owner, due date, evidence of effectiveness and escalation for overdue or ineffective treatment. Material findings are reported to the ARC, Academic Board where academic matters arise, and Board as appropriate.

11. Legislative and Governance Framework

This Policy operates with the Higher Education Standards Framework (Threshold Standards) 2021; Education Services for Overseas Students Act 2000 and National Code 2018 (particularly Standard 6); applicable NSW and Victorian WHS legislation; Privacy Act 1988; and other relevant emergency, child safety, discrimination and education obligations where applicable. Statutory notifications and timeframes must be checked against the law applying at the time of the incident.

This Policy is subordinate to applicable law and the TIIS Constitution. It must be read with the Governance Charter and Delegations of Authority; no emergency response delegation permits the exercise of matters reserved to Members except as lawfully authorised.

12. Related TIIS Documents

This Policy and Procedure should be read in conjunction with the following TIIS documents, as applicable: References to the Crisis Management Plan, Sexual Harm Prevention and Response Policy and Data and Cybersecurity Policy are conditional on verification of current approved versions. Pending verification, the CEO must apply this Policy, applicable legislation and approved operational arrangements; unapproved documents must not be represented as implemented controls.

1. Student Safety and Security Procedure
2. Work Health and Safety Policy
3. Risk Management Policy
4. Crisis Management Policy (1draft)
5. Crisis Management Plan (originally **TIIS Specific Crisis Management Plan to Suspension**)
6. Student Support and Wellbeing Policy
7. Sexual Harm Prevention and Response Policy
8. Data and Cybersecurity Policy
9. Records Management Policy

13. Implementation and Review

The CEO must ensure the Critical Incident Register (SE22) is established, current and available as auditable CRICOS evidence before lodgement. The Registrar is the register custodian and reports to the ARC quarterly. The CEO must maintain an operational incident response procedure, escalation/contact list, incident log template, regulatory notification checklist and staff training arrangements. The procedure must include designated incident coordinators and alternates for each campus, with current contact details held in a controlled operational contact list. This Policy is reviewed at least every two years or earlier after a significant incident, legislative change, delivery change or identified control failure. EMT may recommend revisions; the Board is the approval authority, subject to the Constitution.

14. Document Control and Implementation Notes

This version consolidates the operational response, recovery, international-student assistance, incident coordination and emergency-contact arrangements of the earlier TIIS Critical Incident Management documents.

Document control	Details
Version	3.0 – Board-approved
Document owner	Chief Executive Officer (CEO) / Registrar
Approval authority	Board of Directors
Approval date / effective date	22 October 2026
Next review	Within two years of approval or earlier following material change
Supersedes	Version 1.3 (approved 30 March 2023); version 2.0 (29 May 2026) was a draft and was not approved.

15. Version History

Version	Approved by	Approval Date	Details
1.0	Executive Management Committee	13 April 2016	Initial version
1.1	Executive Management Committee	7 July 2020	Minor amendments
1.2	Executive Management Committee	14 October 2020	Minor amendments
1.3	Executive Management Committee	30/03/2023	Minor amendments
2.0	Draft — not approved	29 May 2026	Unapproved redevelopment draft; retained in history only.
3.0	Board of Directors	22 October 2026	Comprehensive redevelopment and consolidation of governance, emergency response, recovery, overseas-student support, incident coordination,

			regulatory reporting and institutional risk management.

Appendix A – Immediate Incident Checklist

- Ensure safety: call 000 if urgent; evacuate, shelter or provide first aid.
- Notify campus lead / Registrar and CEO immediately for suspected critical incidents.
- Record time, location, known facts, affected persons and immediate action; preserve evidence.
- Activate CIMT and coordinate welfare, continuity, privacy and communications.
- Identify and meet each applicable statutory notification and recordkeeping obligation.
- Document recovery actions, review findings, owners, due dates and verified closure.

Appendix B – Operational Response and Recovery Procedure

1. Immediate response

Any person identifying imminent danger must call 000, alert those at risk and follow campus evacuation or shelter instructions. Do not wait for management approval to obtain emergency assistance. Preserve life before property or evidence.

2. Initial notification and coordination

Notify the campus lead, Registrar or available senior manager and the CEO as soon as safe. The CEO appoints an incident coordinator and activates a proportionate Critical Incident Management Team (CIMT). The designated WHS officer or warden coordinates on-site safety within their competence; emergency services retain command of their operations.

3. Initial incident assessment

Record what happened, when and where, persons affected or missing, immediate threats, assistance required, witnesses, actions taken and unresolved facts. Classify severity provisionally; do not speculate or disclose identities unnecessarily.

4. First 24 hours – stabilisation

Confirm safety and welfare, obtain verified facts, contact relevant authorities and insurers where required, preserve evidence and records, identify statutory reporting duties, brief the CEO and Board Chair where material, and establish a communication and continuity plan.

5. Next 48–72 hours – recovery

Review welfare needs and delayed trauma responses; arrange counselling and specialist referral, alternate premises or online learning, data restoration and staffing coverage where safe. Provide accurate updates to affected students and staff and track outstanding actions.

6. Following two weeks and beyond

Continue individual follow-up, academic and employment adjustments, continuity monitoring and communications as appropriate. Complete a proportionate post-incident evaluation once stabilised, including feedback from affected persons where appropriate and safe.

7. Closure and assurance

Record causes, decisions, notification evidence, action owners and deadlines; report material findings through the EMT and relevant governance bodies. Verify control effectiveness before closure and update the Institutional Risk Register where warranted.

Appendix C – International Student Assistance and Academic Continuity

For an overseas student affected by a critical incident, the Registrar and Academic Dean must assess whether the event impairs the student's capacity to commence, attend, progress in or complete the course. Support may include:

- accessible advice on emergency, health, counselling and welfare services, including interpreter assistance where reasonably necessary;
- reasonable assessment adjustments, extensions, alternative classes, academic support and approved study arrangements;
- consideration of deferral, suspension or other enrolment changes under the relevant TIIS policy and ESOS requirements;
- consideration of fee or financial assistance under approved TIIS policy and delegated authority;
- contact with family, guardians, sponsors or consular representatives only where appropriate and lawful, taking account of consent, privacy and safety;
- assessment of whether PRISMS action or other notification is legally required; an incident does not automatically require PRISMS reporting.

All assistance and decisions must be documented in appropriate restricted student records. The Student Safety and Security Procedure and relevant student support, complaints and critical incident processes operate together.

Appendix D – Incident Management Roles and Records

Role	Operational responsibility
CEO / Incident Controller	Direct institutional response; appoint coordinator; approve communications; ensure escalation, resources and statutory notifications.
Campus incident coordinator / WHS lead	Coordinate immediate on-site safety, wardens, emergency services liaison, factual incident log and site controls.
Registrar / Student Services	Identify affected students; arrange welfare contact and support; coordinate enrolment and PRISMS assessment.
Academic Dean / Course Coordinators	Arrange academic continuity, assessment adjustments and monitoring of academic impacts.
ICT / Facilities / Finance leads	Manage specialist recovery, premises, systems, evidence and financial continuity within delegated authority.
Quality and Compliance Manager	Advise on reporting requirements, monitor completion, sample records and provide second-line assurance; not first-line incident owner.

The CIMT is activated according to incident needs; its membership is not fixed. The EMT supports coordination but has no additional collective approval powers unless expressly delegated.

The Registrar maintains the Critical Incident Register (SE22) and ensures quarterly reporting to the ARC. Maintain an incident record showing report source; event date and location; affected persons; severity and risk assessment; emergency actions; coordinator; communications; welfare support; regulator notification assessment, decisions and timestamps; continuity measures; evidence preservation; review findings; corrective actions and closure verification.

Appendix E – Emergency Contact and Site-Readiness Controls

TIIS must maintain an up-to-date, controlled Emergency Contact List for its Sydney and Melbourne campuses, including campus management, the CEO or authorised delegates, first aid officers, emergency wardens, building management, ICT support and relevant external emergency services.

Each campus must maintain accessible emergency evacuation diagrams, designated assembly points, arrangements for persons requiring assistance and appropriate emergency response instructions. These arrangements must be communicated, regularly reviewed and tested in accordance with the TIIS Work Health and Safety Policy.

Emergency Services (Australia): 000 (Police, Fire and Ambulance).

For offshore or Transnational Education (TNE) delivery, TIIS must ensure that relevant delivery partners maintain appropriate local emergency contacts, response procedures and escalation arrangements consistent with applicable local requirements and TIIS oversight responsibilities.

Accountability: Campus management is responsible for maintaining local emergency arrangements and verifying contact details. The CEO oversees institutional readiness and ensures material deficiencies are addressed promptly.

Document Control: Emergency contact lists must be reviewed periodically and whenever personnel or contact details change. Unverified historical contact information must not be relied upon for emergency response.